

Real-World Scrum Scenarios

A collection of 15 real-world scenarios designed to test your practical knowledge of Scrum roles and responsibilities. These situations cover team dynamics, stakeholder collaboration, product planning, and Agile values. Ideal for Scrum Masters and Product Owners looking to improve decision-making in complex environments.

Answers are provided at the end of the page for self-check and reflection.

SCENARIO 1

Multiple Scrum Teams have started working on a product. The Portfolio Manager asked the Product Owner how much time it would take to reach the third release designated in the Product Roadmap. At that point, the end-users would be able to start using the product and this would increase revenue. The Product Owner discussed with the teams and they provided a forecast of 6 to 9 months. However, after 7 months of development, the Scrum Teams are not near the third release. They would need 4 more months to get to the stage the Portfolio Manager wants the product to be in. As a result, he is disappointed and angry. How would you help the Product Owner in this situation?

(Choose the best answer)

A) You suggest hiring new developers to speed up the development. Depending on the budget the organization can allocate, the Product Owner should decide how many new developers should be hired.

B) You present to the Product Owner a Product Backlog prioritization technique called MosCow (must have, should have, could have, will not have). Then identify and remove any “could have” and “will not have” PBIs. This would save a lot of time because the developers would be focused on the essential PBIs for the third release.

C) You suggest doing longer Sprints and reducing the duration of the events. So the developers can get more done during the Sprints.

D) You suggest the Product Owner collaborate with the Portfolio Manager on refining the Product Backlog and discuss a future delivery date.

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SCENARIO 2

The Product Owner has been attending Daily Scrum so that each developer can report the progress of the tasks they've been working on. The Scrum Team is new and the developers are okay with that. You are the Scrum Master. What would be the best thing to do in this situation?

(Choose the best answer)

- A)** Politely explain to the Product Owner that he or she should not attend the Daily Scrum events. Only the Developers should participate.
- B)** Coach the members of the Scrum Team on the purpose of Daily Scrum. Encourage self-correction.
- C)** Nothing. All members of the Scrum Team are allowed to attend the Daily Scrum event, including the Product Owner.
- D)** Facilitate the Daily Scrum events so the interaction between the Developers and the Product Owner goes smoothly.

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SCENARIO 3

Susan is a developer in a Scrum Team. She has a lot of experience and knowledge. Her contribution to the development of the Product is huge. However, she doesn't see any value in the Daily Scrum events. So, she routinely skips them. The rest of the developers do not do anything about that situation. What would you do as a Scrum Master?

(Choose the best answer)

- A)** Remind all developers what the purpose of Daily Scrum is. Ask them what would happen if not all of them participate.
- B)** Start attending every Daily Scrum to make sure Susan doesn't miss another event.
- C)** Do nothing. The developers are responsible for conducting Daily Scrum and resolving any impediments regarding the event.
- D)** Take Susan aside and tell her to always attend Daily Scrum.

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SCENARIO 4

A Scrum Team has been working on a website for seven Sprints without a release. Recently the website has been released. The end-users are happy about it. They like and use most of the features the Developers built during the past seven Sprints. However, many end-users complain about the loading speed of the website. It is slow. A representative of the end-users shares that with the Product Owner. What would you advise the Product Owner to do?

(Choose the best answer)

- A)** Tell the Developers to add performance tests to the Definition of Done.
- B)** Explain to the Product Owner that it would be best to share this concern with the whole Scrum Team so collaboratively, they can decide how to approach the issue.
- C)** Obviously, there is an issue with the Definition of Done. The Scrum Team revises it during Sprint Retrospective. Advise the Product Owner to wait for the event and share the concern.
- D)** In Scrum, the Developers commit to excellence. Releasing a slow website is unacceptable. Encourage the Product Owner to find who from the quality assurance team tested the website before the last release and have a serious talk with him or her.

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SCENARIO 5

Monica, a highly productive and experienced back-end developer in a Scrum Team, constantly argues with the other team members. She makes comments that their ideas are not good enough and she almost always disagrees with team decisions. As a Scrum Master, what would you do in this situation?

(Choose two answers)

- A)** You speak with Monica privately and tell her to respect team decisions. A group of people always makes a better decision compared to a decision made by one person, no matter how smart he or she is.

B) You explain the situation to the HR department. Ask them if there is another team Monica can be moved to.

C) During Sprint Retrospective, you pay attention to the dynamics between the developers and more specifically if anyone would raise the issue with Monica's behavior. You facilitate the discussion and ask questions to get to the root cause of the issue.

D) Even though Monica is experienced and productive, she is clearly an impediment. As a Scrum Master, you have the authority to remove her from the team. After all, you are responsible for the team's health and value delivery.

E) Not all of the developers are comfortable speaking up during official Scrum Events. Steve, who specializes in quality assurance, comes to you and shares how Monica's behaviour is disruptive. It affects the team's productivity. You offer to help initiate a discussion but also you encourage Steve to share with the entire team.

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SCENARIO 6

Joshua, a Product Owner, has been tracking the progress of the Sprint every day. The Scrum Team does one-month Sprints. Now is day 15 and Joshua saw that only 40% of the items in the Sprint Backlog are done (based on the Definition of Done). He comes to you and shares that the team should be at around 50 or 60% done items. Joshua is concerned that the Developers didn't do an accurate forecast and they won't be able to meet it. You are the Scrum Master. What would be the best thing to do?

(Choose the best answer)

A) Coach the Developers on how to meet their Sprint forecasts. Explain the importance of considering their Past Performance and the Definition of Done when they select items for the Sprint Backlog.

B) Discuss with the HR department that Joshua does a great job as a Product Owner and would be even more successful if we hire more developers. This would have a positive impact on speed and value delivery.

C) As a Scrum Master, you are accountable for the team's effectiveness. You must find a way to motivate the Developers to meet their forecast.

D) Coach Joshua that the team commits to the Sprint Goal and not to the initial forecast. Explain that the primary objective is achieving the Sprint Goal.

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SCENARIO 7

During the Sprint Review, the VP (Vice President) of marketing is excited and announces to the Scrum Team that a big deal has been closed. A company with 520 employees is going to start using the Product. The CTO (Chief Technical Officer) comments that the Product cannot handle 520 more people as the user base is already large. Also, he adds it is important the Scrum Team works on non-functional requirements with regard to scalability. The Product Owner knows that this is not the first time scalability has been a challenge. The participants of the Sprint Review start discussing ways to approach this. As a Scrum Master, what would you support?

(Choose two answers)

A) During the Sprint Retrospective event, the Scrum Team discusses appropriate changes to the Definition of Done so handling scalability concerns is easier in the future.

B) Non-functional requirements should be handled by a separate component team that specializes in scalability and maintainability. They should work alongside the Scrum Team. In this way, there won't be any delays with business functionality.

C) The Product Owner should postpone the upcoming Sprint and have the teamwork only on scalability. Once all of the PBIs related to scalability are done, the PO resumes sprinting.

D) Non-functional requirements related to scalability are added to the Product Backlog. The Scrum Team may focus most of its effort on those PBIs, however, they should also create some business-facing functionality, regardless of how small it is.

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SCENARIO 8

An organization that has been using a plan-driven approach to development for 13 years, wants to transition to an adaptive approach - agile. As a framework, they chose Scrum. Right now, the company has several teams each working on different layers of

the product (e.g. front-end, back-end). These are called Component Teams. As a Scrum Master, you need to help the organization with the transition. One of the first things you do is to introduce the concept of Feature Teams. You underline the importance of cross-functionality and delivering a done increment each Sprint. What should you consider when moving from Component Teams to Feature Teams?

(Choose two answers)

A) Usually, a new Scrum Team goes through a few phases before it starts performing. This requires time.

B) Feature teams are not immediately productive. Initially, the productivity of the new Scrum Team may be low.

C) It is way easier to normalize the velocity of feature teams as opposed to component teams. This will help the manager determine which teams are underperforming.

D) You would need the CVs of the members of the organization so it is easier for you to decide which team to assign the people to. In this way, you would truly form cross-functional teams.

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SCENARIO 9

A company adopting Scrum wants to build 3 brand-new products. The CEO asks you how many Product Owners there should be.

(Choose two answers)

A) One Product Owner for all three products. If necessary, the Product Owner may delegate work.

B) One Product Owner for each product.

C) It depends on the scale of the Products and the number of developers in each Scrum Team. On bigger products, there can be multiple Product Owners as long as one is assigned as chief. So, there can be more than 3 Product Owners for the three products.

D) There must be one Product Owner for each product because product backlog management activities cannot be delegated.

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SCENARIO 10

You are a Scrum Master in a high-performing Scrum Team that has been regularly delivering product increments for 15 Sprints. The current Product Owner, Peter, has been promoted to Portfolio Manager in the organization. A new one, Rachel, has been assigned to the team. Rachel doesn't have much experience with Scrum, but she is eager to learn. You have to explain to her the concept of done PBIs. Choose the sentences that are true about done PBIs.

(Choose three answers)

- A)** The PBIs are completed based on the agreed Definition of Done.
- B)** The code for the PBIs is written without any technical debt and 0 known defects.
- C)** The code for the PBIs is 100% written, and only testing is left.
- D)** Each PBI can be considered an increment and can be released.
- E)** The acceptance criteria for each PBI are 100% met.
- F)** During the Sprint Review, the Product Owner should NOT present PBIs that are not done.

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SCENARIO 11

What is true about the Daily Scrum event?

(Select all that apply)

- A)** It is a maximum of 15 minutes.
- B)** It is held at the same time and place to reduce complexity.

- C)** The Developers are required to participate.
- D)** If the Scrum Master and the Product Owner work as developers, they are required to participate.
- E)** The Developers choose the structure of the event but the main focus should be on progress toward the Sprint Goal and a plan on what to do next.

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SCENARIO 12

You are a Product Owner, and you've used Stakeholder Analysis to identify and manage the key stakeholders. There are several stakeholders in your organization with high influence. Quite often, there are contradictions of opinions. You are faced with the following situation. The CMO (Chief Marketing Officer) insists you implement a set of features that would help the product reach a wider audience. On the other hand, the CEO (Chief Executive Officer - the highest level of corporate executive) argues that the investment to develop the set of features the CMO proposes is significant. Instead, the CEO proposes looking for ways to better satisfy the existing customers. You make the decision. What would you do?

(Choose the best answer)

- A)** Ignore the opinion of the CMO because the CEO is the highest level of a corporate executive.
- B)** Create a Product Goal around the set of features the CMO proposes. Order the Product Backlog accordingly and explain to the Developers the importance of the features.
- C)** Run an experiment to find out if there is an untapped market as the CMO suggests.
- D)** Chances are, the CMO has a better awareness of the end-users' needs than the CEO. Opportunities do not last forever, so interrupt the work of the current Sprint and explain the set of PBIs to the Developers. In this way, the Developers would be able to start working on them immediately.

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SCENARIO 13

Ken, an inexperienced Product Owner has been assigned to your Scrum Team. He is eager to learn and satisfy the stakeholders. For that reason, Ken constantly seeks feedback from them during the Sprint. However, instead of updating the Product Backlog, Ken constantly updates the Sprint Backlog. The Developers grow angry with this practice. They see no way of achieving the Sprint Goal. The Product Owner is not fully aware of why this is the case. The PBIs the PO adds to the Sprint Backlog would bring more value than those that are already there. The Product Owner knows that their primary accountability is value maximization. What would you do as a Scrum Master?

(Choose the best answer)

- A)** Report Ken to the hiring Manager. The Product Owner does not understand the basic principles of Scrum.
- B)** Talk to the Product Owners of the other Scrum Teams within the organization. Choose one that agrees to join the team and work with Ken for several Sprints. There will be 2 Product Owners during that time but this is the fastest way for Ken to get up to speed with Product Ownership and value delivery.
- C)** Coach the Developers that they must respect the Product Owner's wishes. Despite the fact Kevin doesn't have experience with Scrum, he frequently communicates with the stakeholders and receives valuable feedback.
- D)** Coach the Product Owner that the purpose of the Sprint is to achieve the Sprint Goal. Yes, the Sprint Backlog changes during the Sprint but not with random PBIs that do not relate to the Sprint Goal and would potentially bring a lot of value. Facilitate a discussion between Ken and the Developers.

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SCENARIO 14

It is the end of Sprint nine. The Scrum Team and stakeholders participate in a Sprint Review event. However, the stakeholders are upset because they think, what the Scrum Team builds is not going to satisfy their needs. What might have led to this?

(Choose the best three answers)

A) The stakeholders have been skipping Sprint Review events. As a result, they haven't inspected the progress of the product development and provided feedback.

B) The stakeholders haven't been participating in the Daily Scrum events to tell the Developers those PBIs that would bring the most value and meet their needs.

C) The project managers haven't been monitoring and controlling the progress of the project. This led to developing the product in the wrong direction.

D) There hasn't been enough transparency.

E) The Product Owner hasn't been actively seeking feedback from the stakeholders during the product development effort.

F) There weren't enough details in the project management plan. So the Product Owner and the Developers made assumptions about what features would be best to develop. These assumptions turned out to be wrong.

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SCENARIO 15

Jessie, a front-end developer has recently joined the Scrum Team. She is new to Scrum but she's read the Scrum Guide. As a developer, the concept of Done grabbed her attention. She wants to learn more about Done PBIs and asks you about the benefits of the Definition of Done. You are the Scrum Master, what would you share with her?

(Choose four answers)

A) It should not change during the product development as it would hurt transparency.

B) It includes all front-end, back-end, database, and architecture work. Only testing is left.

C) It helps the Product Owner understand the progress of the Sprint.

D) It helps the Scrum Master track the progress of the Developers during the Sprint and makes changes to the Sprint Backlog if necessary.

E) It creates transparency into the state of the Increment.

F) It helps the Developers during Sprint Planning when they select PBIs for the Sprint Backlog.

G) It helps the Developers know how much work is left to create the increment.

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ANSWERS

Scenario - Correct Answer(s)

1 - D

2 - B

3 - A

4 - B

5 - C, E

6 - D

7 - A, D

8 - A, B

9 - A, B

10 - A, D, F

11 - A, B, C, D, E

12 - C,

13 - D,

14 - A, D, E

15 - C, E, F, G